can then be dried in shade and roasted lightly on a tawa. They can be ground and used in many dishes. Pulses are also sprouted first and then steamed and consumed. The time and water which each grain or pulse needs for soaking and sprouting is different. Normally 8–16 hours are needed for soaking and 12–24 hours for sprouting. The cloth in which the soaked dhal is tied should be kept moist all the time.

Germination helps

i) Increase the digestibility of food
   a) Some carbohydrates and proteins are broken down into smaller and easily digestible forms.
   b) Grains and pulses become soft after sprouting, so they take less time for cooking and are easy for you to digest.

ii) Increase the nutritive value of food with no additional cost

Some vitamins and minerals become more when foods are germinated Vitamin B becomes almost double in quantity while vitamin C increases almost 10 times.

3.8 KITCHEN EQUIPMENT

Knowing the names and uses of equipment is as important as knowing where to find them in a kitchen.

Minor Equipment: The small equipment that we use in the kitchen for food are known as minor equipment.

Measuring equipment

- dry measuring cups for solid ingredients
- measuring spoons for small amounts
- liquid measuring cup with space at top
- spatula to level off dry ingredients

Slicing and Cutting Tools

- paring knife cleans/pares fruits and vegetables
- utility knife for all cutting purposes
- butcher knife-heavy duty for large cuts of meat
- bread knife has serrated edge
- chef's knife/French knife for slice, dice, chop a triangle blade
- slicing knife has a long narrow blade used for meat and cabbage
- carving knife for meat
- peeler for peeling fruits and vegetables
- kitchen shears
- cutting board
- grater
- mixing tools
- baking tools
- cooking tools
- kitchen aids
- cookware
- cleaning equipment

The minor kitchen equipment is used mostly for prepreparation of foods.

Major Equipment: The major kitchen equipment that are used for everyday cooking would include a food processor (mixee cum grinder/blender), refrigerator, microwave oven and even a small non-commercial oven cum toaster and grill.

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